

UNIT 3 / People and things

Meet the family

Your goal: Describe family relationships with *mein* and *meine*.

01 Learn the idea

Start with family words: *der Vater*, *die Mutter*, *der Bruder*, *die Schwester* and *das Kind*. Use *mein* with a masculine or neuter subject and *meine* with a feminine or plural subject: *mein Bruder*, *meine Schwester*, *meine Eltern*. The ending follows the noun, not the gender of the person speaking.

Introduce a relative using *Das ist* and add a name or age. For more than one person, use *Das sind meine Eltern*. Remember that *Geschwister* means siblings and is used in the plural. You can describe an invented family or chosen family for practice; the grammar works the same way.

Words and phrases

German	English
mein Vater	my father
meine Mutter	my mother
mein Bruder	my brother
meine Schwester	my sister
meine Eltern	my parents

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Das ist meine Schwester. Sie heißt Anna.

This is my sister. Her name is Anna.

Ben

Wie alt ist sie?

How old is she?

Mia

Sie ist achtzehn.

She is eighteen.

Your real-life mission

Make a small fictional family tree. Introduce four people using mein or meine and give two of their ages.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “mein Vater” mean?

- A. my mother
- B. my father
- C. my brother

2. What does “meine Mutter” mean?

- A. my brother
- B. my sister
- C. my mother

3. What does “mein Bruder” mean?

- A. my brother
- B. my sister
- C. my parents

4. Complete: Das ist ____ Schwester.

- A. mein
- B. meine
- C. meinen

5. Who is Anna?

- A. Mia's mother
- B. Mia's sister
- C. Ben's sister

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. B - my father

“mein Vater” means “my father”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. C - my mother

“meine Mutter” means “my mother”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. A - my brother

“mein Bruder” means “my brother”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - meine

Schwester is feminine, so the basic possessive form is meine.

5. B - Mia's sister

Mia introduces Anna as meine Schwester.

One possible mission response

Das ist mein Vater. Das ist meine Mutter. Meine Schwester heißt Anna. Sie ist achtzehn.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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